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**“Our poverty in 2011-12 was somewhere around 20% or so. In the latest survey (for which full unit-level data is yet to be released), it is clear that extreme poverty has fallen below 3-4%, down from 20%”**

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come and wealth share is a common one that alarmists love to use. The point is that if a country is generating wealth, somebody will have to generate it. And even if

they were keeping 2-3% of that wealth for themselves, [they are] distributing the rest of it across the rest of the population. Look at the sheer numbers when you have got 1.4 billion people. So, you could choose not to create wealth, and everybody could stay poor. Or you could create wealth, and some people will get wealthier. I don't lose sleep over that, because after a point, the main function of it is not so much the consumption of wealth, but a matter of how you allocate that wealth for further growth.

The second aspect is what kind of inequality really offends us? Generally, what we lose sleep over is within our own immediate social context. If I have a colleague at Columbia, who is given a salary increase of 20% and I get only 5%, that really is something over which I will lose sleep. But if a billionaire makes another billion or five in any given year, it doesn't matter to me.